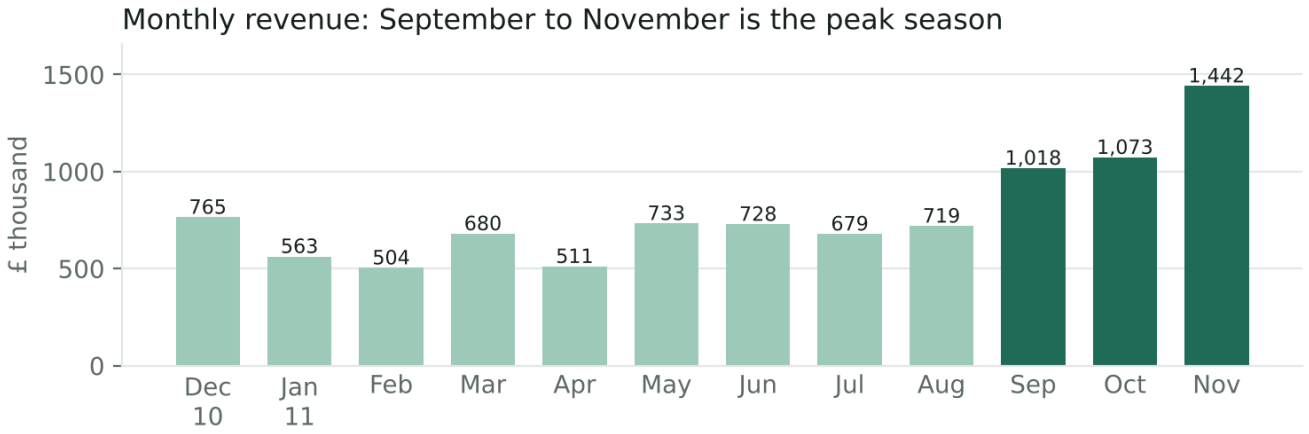
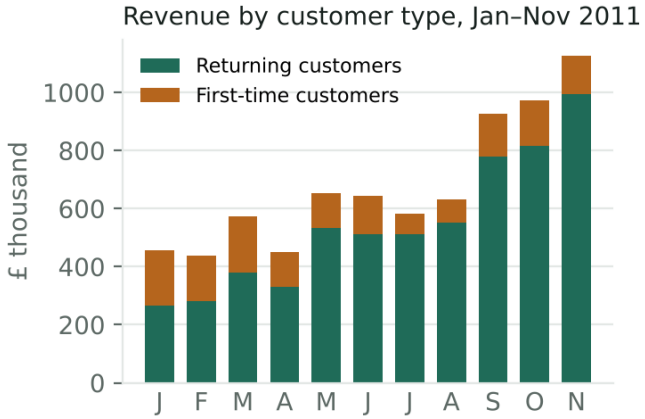
Prepared by Aldo Fransisco

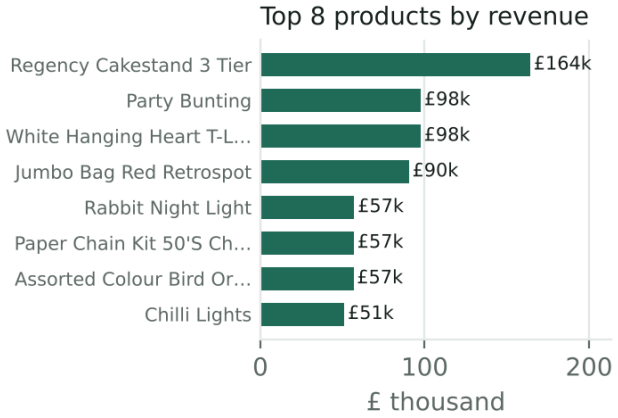
Sales peak in autumn, and repeat buyers carry the year

12 months, Dec 2010 - Nov 2011 · product sales only, after data cleaning · amounts in GBP

£9.41M	18,883	£499	4,284
revenue	orders	average order	known customers







What the data says, and what to do

Plan for the autumn peak

September to November brought in **38%** of the year's revenue in three months. November alone (£1.44M) was **2.9×** February. Christmas products grew from 1.7% of sales in July to 12% in November.

Action: Order Christmas stock and plan warehouse staff by July, and launch seasonal lines in August so they are in stock before the September jump.

Look after the best customers

Returning customers produced **80%** of known-customer revenue from January to November. The top 428 customers (10%) account for **60%** of known-customer revenue, while 36% of customers ordered only once.

Action: Give the top 428 accounts early access to the autumn range and a named contact. Send one-time buyers a reorder reminder 30 days after their first order.

Focus the range

The best-selling 20% of products (758 of 3,793) earn **78%** of revenue. The UK accounts for 85% of sales.

Action: Never let the top 758 products run out. Review the slowest sellers each quarter and clear or drop the ones that tie up stock without adding sales.

Data: UCI Online Retail dataset (Chen, 2015), CC BY 4.0. Dec 2011 excluded (only 9 days of data).
Customer figures use the 85% of revenue that has a customer ID; guest-checkout sales have none.